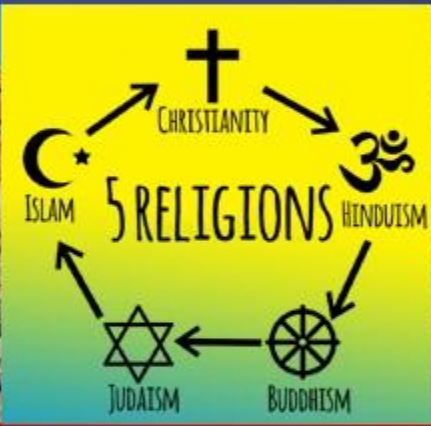


ART & CULTURE



INDIAN THEATRE

MODULE - 1

TRADITIONAL THEATRE FORMS

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE



- 1 Living traditions occupy a prominent place in the Indian social system.
- 2 Any living tradition has a **natural flow**.
- 3 There can be no doubt about the fact that traditional art forms reflect the **ideals of the society, its determination to survive, its ethos, emotions, fellow-feelings, and so on.**
- 4 Theatre in itself is a **complete form of art**. It includes in its framework acting, dialogue, poetry, music, etc.

Theatre is a living tradition!

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

HOW IS SINGING IMPORTANT IN THEATRE?

6

When there is intensity of **emotions**, there is a natural kind of rhythm in their expressions of music .

5

This kind of creativity is **spontaneous**, emerging from the circumstances.

4

Traditionally the **language** of ordinary people has an element of creativity, though not based on classical or grammatical roots.

Importance of
singing
in theatre

1

In community living, the art of singing has its own importance.

2

In all the traditional theatre-forms, songs and the art of singing have an important role to play.

3

Traditional music of the theatre is an **expression** of the feelings of the community.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT IS THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN
COMMON MAN AND THEATRE

COMMON MAN & THEATRE

1

In this art form, sorrow, joy, frustration, hatred and love have their own role and place.

2

In different regions of India, there are religious festivals, fairs, gatherings, ritual offerings, prayers, almost throughout the year.

3

During these occasions, traditional theatre forms are presented.

4

They reflect the common man's social attitudes and perceptions.

Thus through this social portrayal, a common man's role is given due importance.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

HOW ARE CLASSICAL THEATRE AND
TRADITIONAL THEATRE LINKED?

- 1 Traditional theatre forms incorporate not only the common man's interests but there is also a classical element in them.
- 2 This classical facet, however, takes on regional, local and folk coloring.
- 3 Traditional art forms have influenced classical art forms and vice-versa.
- 4 It is possible, that those associated with the classical world of Sanskrit drama, went to the neighbouring regions after its decline and intermingled with the local theatre forms.
- 5 This kind of synthesis, give-and-take must have taken place on various levels such as written, verbal, classical, contemporary, national and local.

Thus there existed a link between Classical Sanskrit theatre and the traditional local theatre forms. This bonding is an eternal journey in the sphere of 'culture'.

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT IS SO SPECIAL ABOUT TRADITIONAL THEATRE?

*Bhand jashn*

- 1 In traditional theatre forms there are special styles of dance portraying the entry on to the stage or platform.
- 2 In this traditional theatre form, emphasis is not only on beauty but on acting itself and narrative and descriptive skills.
- 3 The art of making the entry by dancing has been perfected in the traditional Kashmiri theatre form, Bhand Jashn.
- 4 The way each character walks and enters the platform, identifies him.

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT IS SO SPECIAL ABOUT TRADITIONAL THEATRE?

- 5 In Koodiyaattam and Ankia Naat, the entry by dancing itself is complicated and artistic.



Ankia naat

- 6 In the forms, the tempo and basic posture and gesture identifies the role of the character.



koodiyattam

In short, acting, presentation skills, narrative and descriptive skills all put together form the traditional theatre.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT ARE THE OTHER SIGNIFICANT CHARACTERISTICS OF TRADITIONAL THEATRE?

POINT NO.1

IMPROVISATION



- 1 In traditional theatre, age-old forms, customs and the desire to improvise are intermingled.

- 2 It is usually when the significant themes are enacted, that the acting restricts itself to traditional norms, not deviating from it.

- 3 But, every time the theme inches towards the contemporary, the actors improvise as far as dialogue delivery is concerned.

- 4 There is always a scope for improvisation and incorporation of new references leading to subtle extension in the story-line.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT ARE THE OTHER SIGNIFICANT CHARACTERISTICS OF TRADITIONAL THEATRE?

POINT NO.2

FORM OF ENTRY AND EXIT IN A STAGE



1 In traditional theatre forms there are certain conventions of presentations depending upon and **changing according** to the form and size of the stage or the platform and other circumstances.

2 There is **no formal setup** governing the entry or exit of the actors.

3 Depending on the situation or context, the actors enter into the stage and enact their role without being formally introduced.

4 After a particular event or incident is over, **all the artists make an exit**, or all of them sit down on the sides of the stage or near the backdrop, conveying the change of a scene.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT ARE THE OTHER SIGNIFICANT CHARACTERISTICS OF TRADITIONAL THEATRE?

POINT NO.3

ACTORS AND AUDIENCE



- 1 In traditional theatre forms, there is no such thing as episodes.
- 2 There is **always continuity** in its theme, structure and presentation.
- 3 There is **direct and intimate communication** between the actors and the audience.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT IS THE COMMON DISTINGUISHING FACTOR CONNECTING ALL THEATRE FORMS?

THE ANSWER IS "SIMPLICITY"



- 1 Traditional theatre forms have a common distinguishing feature that is the element of simplicity.
- 2 Traditional theatre forms have definitely been influenced by modernisation, industrialization, and urbanization.
- 3 But, in spite of this urbanisation element influencing the theatre art, **they have always maintained their simplicity which easily connects them to masses.**

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT IS THE UNDERLYING FORCE OF TRADITIONAL THEATRE FORMS THAT HAS ENABLED IT TO SURVIVE AND MAINTAIN ITS SIMPLICITY?



1

It is the *immediate, direct, realistic and rhythmic relationship* that the spectators are able to develop with the artists of traditional theatre forms which is generally not experienced in other art forms.

2

Secondly the development of traditional theatre forms is based on *such local and regional peculiarities which are not bound and restricted by social and economic divisions, limitations, etc.*

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

Qn

WHAT IS THE UNDERLYING FORCE OF TRADITIONAL THEATRE FORMS THAT HAS ENABLED IT TO SURVIVE AND MAINTAIN ITS SIMPLICITY?



3 Dialogue delivery is usually carried out in a high pitch. This helps the actors in reaching out to a larger audience.

4 The artists always add something or the other to the original dialogue on their own.

5 The changes brought through improvisations, make the spectators ecstatic.

6 Also, it establishes a direct relationship between the artists and the spectators.

7 All this is reflected in the applaud by the spectators by means of clapping their hands.

INDIAN THEATRE

TRADITIONAL THEATRE

ROLE OF CLOWN IN A THEATRE



1 The clown also plays a similar role.

2 While being humorous, he also touches upon the socio-economic, political issues and situations with lot of satire.

3 There are different methods too, in the way the clown makes his appearance.

4 If the king, in traditional theatre forms, decides on a step not beneficial for the people at large, the clown appears and takes the side of the common man.

5 He makes the audience laugh and at the same time discloses the anti-people attitude of the king.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao
K. Srikanth
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu
M. Binukrishna
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9